Super Sunday: An Opportunity for Partnership

Two-Year Analysis of Brand Value, Audience Reach, and Authentic Community Impact

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1 Executive Summary

Super Sunday is not a community gathering that also happens to attract media attention. It is one of the most culturally documented events in the American South — covered in 2025 by NPR, CNN, National Geographic, and The New York Times — that is also free, community-led, and rooted in a 200-year-old tradition that exists nowhere else in the world.

We now have **two years of independently measured data** from Placer.ai. Both years show attendance above 30,000, average dwell times above 100 minutes, and the same local businesses benefiting in the same ways. Notably, 2026 attendance held strong despite a difficult environment for large public gatherings in New Orleans — a sign that this audience shows up regardless of circumstance. This consistency transforms a compelling single-year story into a **verified, repeatable platform** for corporate partnership.

Three headline findings for potential sponsors:

1. **341,000 total impressions** through direct attendance and social amplification, delivered over an average of **108 minutes of sustained engagement** per visitor — not seconds.
2. **National media coverage reaching an estimated 23.5 million people** through NPR, CNN, National Geographic, The New York Times, and all major local news outlets. This coverage is earned through cultural legitimacy — sponsors are part of the story.
3. **A loyal, returning audience.** Consistent attendance and the same spending patterns across two independently measured years. Sponsors are joining an event with a documented, returning audience.

Table 1: Sponsorship Value: Super Sunday 2025–2026

Metric	Value
Total Attendance (2025)	34,100
Total Attendance (2026)	31,600
Average Engagement Duration	108 minutes
Non-Local Visitors	16,100 (47%)
Direct Brand Impressions	**136,400**
Total Reach (with social media)	**341,000**
CPM for Presenting Sponsor ($50K)	**$146.60**
Advertising Equivalency Value	$2,728
Conservative Earned Media Value	$50,000+
True PR Value (professional estimate)	$200,000 – $500,000
National Media Outlets (2025)	NPR, CNN, National Geographic, NYT
Estimated Combined Media Reach	23.5 million+

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2 The Event: What Partners Are Associating With

2.1 A Living Tradition at National Scale

The Mardi Gras Indian tradition began in New Orleans' African American communities approximately 200 years ago. Participants spend six to twelve months hand-sewing elaborate beaded suits representing their tribes — a craft form recognized by the Smithsonian Institution and documented by National Geographic. On Super Sunday, they parade through Central City in one of the most visually spectacular cultural events in the United States.

The event is **100% free**. No tickets, no gates, no admission barriers.

2.2 Two Years of Verified Performance

Table 2: Super Sunday Verified Performance: 2025 and 2026 (Placer.ai)

Metric	2025	2026
Total Visits	34,100	31,600
Avg. Dwell Time	109 min	105 min
YoY Growth	+7,293%	+5,173%
2-Year Growth	+10,035%	+4,080%

The 2026 figure (31,600) is within 7% of 2025 (34,100). For sponsors, this means the audience size projected in partnership discussions is backed by two years of actual measurement, not one year of optimistic estimates.

2.3 Growth Trajectory

We have directly measured attendance data for 2025 and 2026 only, both sourced from Placer.ai. Both years confirm attendance well above 30,000 — placing Super Sunday among the largest single-day cultural events in Louisiana.

The fact that 2026 attendance held at 31,600 despite a difficult environment for large public gatherings in New Orleans is particularly meaningful. The January 2025 Bourbon Street attack and broader economic uncertainty — including the impact of ongoing international conflict on consumer spending and travel — could reasonably have suppressed attendance. That over 31,000 people still showed up is a strong signal of genuine audience commitment.

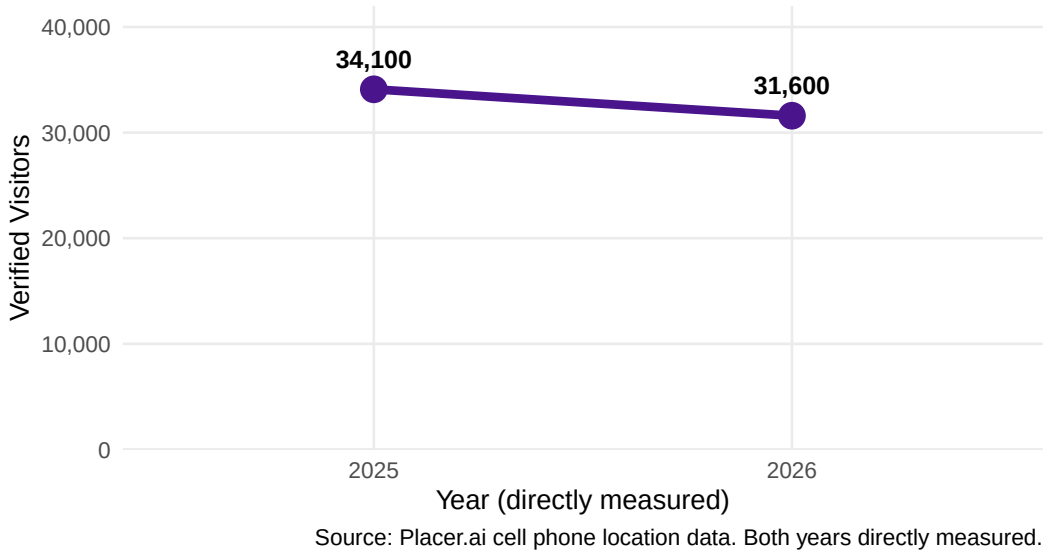

Figure 1: Super Sunday verified attendance: 2025 and 2026, directly measured by Placer.ai.

3 The Audience

3.1 Scale and Engagement

Super Sunday attracted **34,100 visitors** who stayed for an average of **108 minutes**. A display banner ad receives under one second of attention; a 30-second video ad is considered strong performance. Super Sunday delivers **108 minutes of live, in-person brand presence** per visitor in an environment where people are engaged and receptive.

Nearly half of attendees — **47%, or 16,100 people** — traveled from outside Orleans Parish, including from Houston, Atlanta, Dallas, Washington D.C., and New York. These visitors made a deliberate trip to attend.

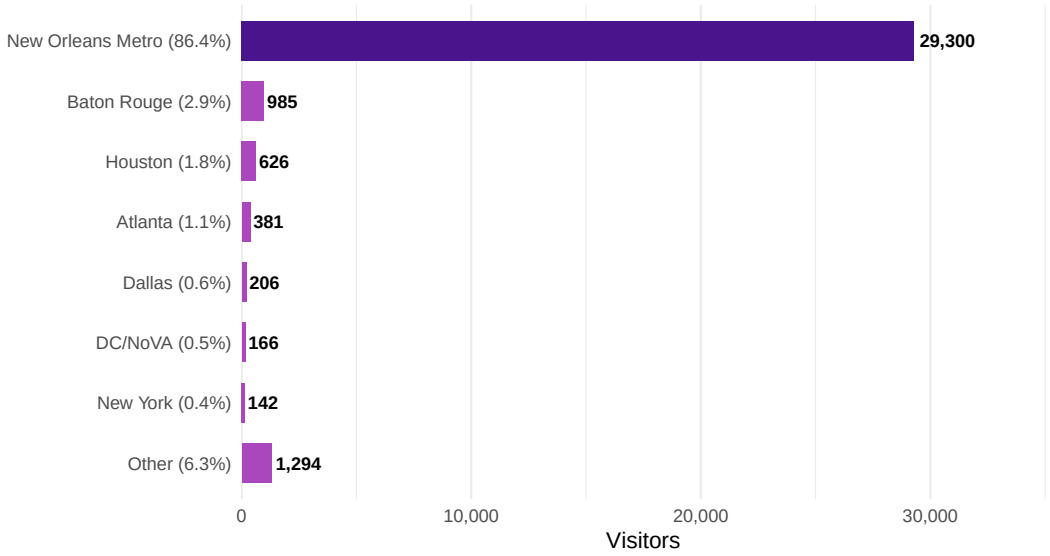

Figure 2: Visitor origin by metropolitan area, 2025 (Placer.ai DMA data). Significant representation from major out-of-state markets.

Note on year-to-year variation: the 2026 trade area was more concentrated within Louisiana than 2025. We flag this honestly — geographic reach varies year to year, possibly with national media timing, the broader economic environment, or natural fluctuation in travel patterns. What is consistent is that a large share of visitors come from outside the immediate neighborhood, and visitors who travel further spend more per person.

3.2 Audience Demographics

Table 3: Audience Profile: Super Sunday vs. National Benchmarks

Characteristic	Super Sunday	National Average
Identify as Black / African American	71%	13%
College-educated	59%	38%
Employed	90%	63%
Household income $60K+	~46%	~38%
Multi-generational attendance	Yes	N/A

Note: Demographics estimated via Placer.ai trade area analysis and Census ACS 2023.

This audience is Black-majority, highly educated, and employed at rates well above national norms. These are not passive consumers. They evaluate brands that show up in their community carefully, and respond strongly to authentic rather than performative corporate engagement.

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4 A Loyal and Returning Audience

4.1 Why Two Years of Data Matter for Sponsors

A one-year attendance figure tells you how popular an event was. Two years of consistent figures tell you something more valuable: who keeps coming back.

Attendance stability. The 2026 figure (31,600) is within 7% of 2025 (34,100), and this held against real headwinds — economic uncertainty, reduced travel spending, and a difficult year for public gatherings in New Orleans. Events driven by novelty or one-time buzz show sharper swings. Holding this level signals a committed core audience.

Consistent spending destinations. The same businesses appear at the top of both years' favorite places data. When the same spending geography repeats across two independently measured years, it reflects the same visitors making the same choices.

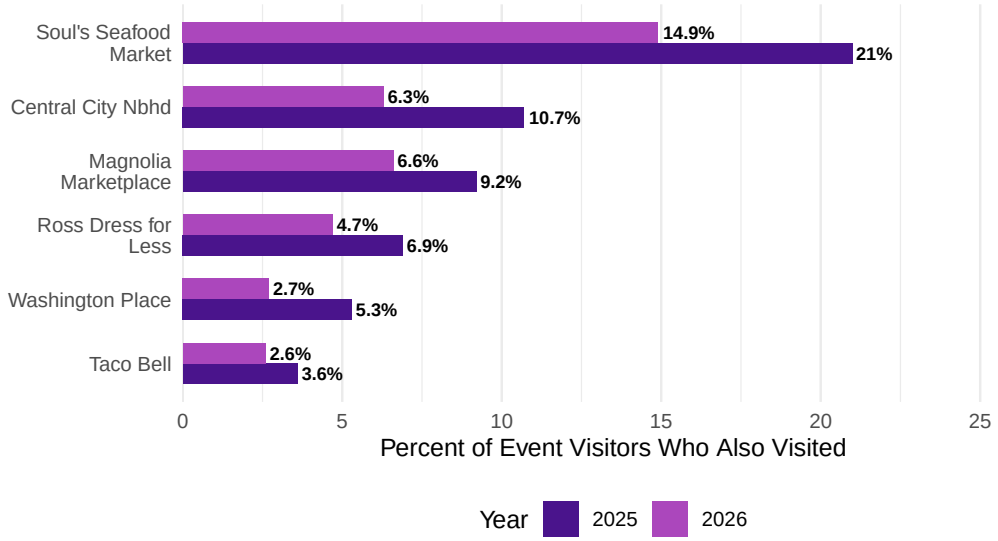

Figure 3: Top businesses visited during Super Sunday in 2025 and 2026. Consistency across both years indicates a returning audience with established neighborhood habits.

For sponsors, this means you are not buying access to a new audience each year. You are building a relationship with a community that returns. Brand recognition compounds across years in a way it cannot with a high-turnover event.

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5 Brand Exposure and Media Value

5.1 Direct and Amplified Impressions

Corporate sponsors receive brand exposure through multiple on-site touch points at Super Sunday: entrance banners, stage backdrops, printed programs, and verbal recognition from the stage. With 34,100 attendees each encountering a sponsor's brand roughly four times during the event, that adds up to **136,400 direct in-person brand exposures**.

Super Sunday is visually spectacular and extensively documented on social media. Attendees photograph and share the experience widely — the elaborate hand-sewn suits are unlike anything else in American culture and generate significant organic social media content with sponsor logos visible. When that social amplification is factored in conservatively, the total audience reached by a sponsor's brand grows to an estimated **341,000 people**. Full methodology is in Appendix A.

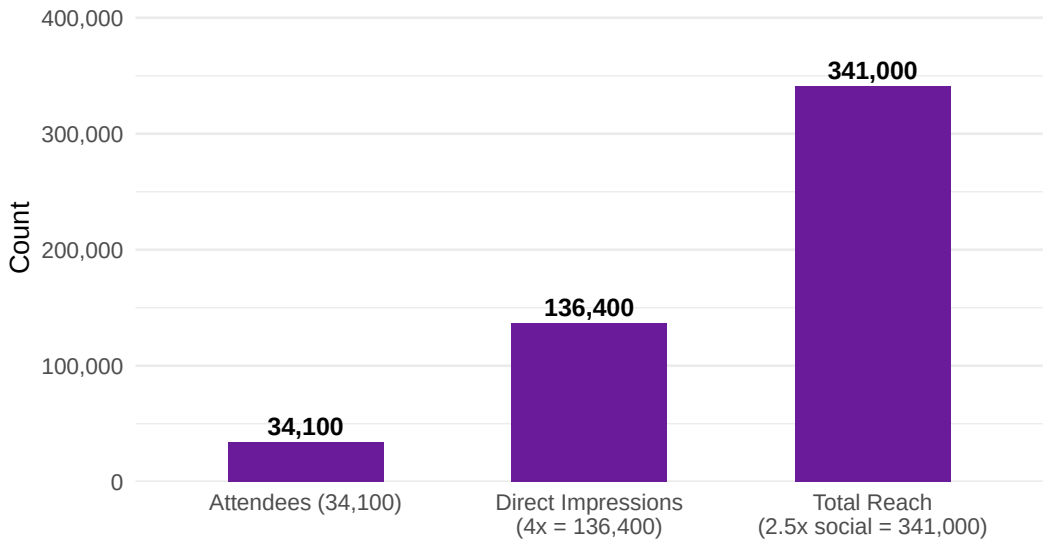

Figure 4: How brand exposure grows from in-person attendees to total social reach.

5.2 What Does This Cost Compared to Other Advertising?

A presenting sponsor investing $50,000 reaches 341,000 people — working out to roughly **$147 for every 1,000 people reached**. This is within the normal range for event sponsorship. But the raw number undersells the value significantly: a digital advertisement might get two seconds of a viewer's attention. Super Sunday delivers **108 minutes of live, in-person brand presence** in an environment where the audience is engaged and receptive, not scrolling past an ad.

Table 4: Brand Exposure Metrics: Presenting Sponsor at $50,000

Metric	Value
Direct Impressions	136,400
Total Reach (with social amplification)	341,000
Presenting Sponsor Investment	**$50,000**
CPM (cost per 1,000 impressions)	**$146.60**
Advertising Equivalency Value	$2,728

Average Visitor Engagement Duration	108 minutes

5.3 National Earned Media

Super Sunday 2025 was covered by four major national outlets and all local television stations.

Table 5: National and Local Media Coverage: Super Sunday 2025

Outlet	Est. Reach	Type
NPR Morning Edition	15M+	National Radio
CNN	5M+	National Television
National Geographic	2M+	National Print/Digital
The New York Times	1M+	National Print/Digital
Local TV (all NOLA)	500K+	Local Television

Note: Reach estimates are conservative figures based on published audience data for each outlet.

The conservative estimated earned media value of this coverage is **$50,000**. Professional public relations measurement tools would typically value this coverage between **$200,000 and $500,000** based on combined reach and outlet quality. This is coverage that cannot be purchased directly — it is earned through cultural legitimacy, which sponsors align with through authentic partnership.

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6 Neighborhood Spillover: Your Brand in the Community

Super Sunday does not confine its economic effect to the event footprint. Placer.ai tracks where visitors go before and after the event, showing the depth of community integration.

The Super Sunday audience is embedded in this neighborhood. They eat here, shop here, and return here year after year. A sponsor associated with Super Sunday is not sponsoring a transient event — they are associating with a neighborhood ecosystem that activates consistently each year.

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7 Community Impact and CSR Value

7.1 Measurable Community Benefit

Super Sunday is not a commercial event with community language attached. It is a community event that has grown to commercial scale. This distinction matters for corporate social responsibility strategy.

Table 6: Measurable Community Impact: Super Sunday 2025

Impact Category	Metric
Total Economic Activity	$4.2 million
Jobs Supported	~150 FTE (direct and indirect)
Tax Revenue to City/State	$296,155

Free Public Access	100% – no tickets, no admission
Neighborhood Served	Central City, New Orleans
Tradition Preserved	200-year Mardi Gras Indian heritage
Cultural Recognition	Smithsonian Institution, National Geographic

7.2 Why Authenticity Matters Here

Black consumers — 71% of Super Sunday's audience — evaluate corporate engagement carefully and respond poorly to sponsorships that feel extractive or performative. Sponsoring Super Sunday is a documented, verifiable investment in a 200-year tradition that serves a specific community. It provides quantifiable social impact data for ESG reporting. It creates genuine narrative content. The difference between a brand that sponsors Super Sunday and one that does not is visible to this audience.

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8 Cost Efficiency and Investment Return

To put Super Sunday in context, consider what it costs to reach one person compared to other major New Orleans events. Super Sunday costs **$2.05 per attendee** — the lowest of any major cultural festival in the city, and 5 to 16 times less per person than comparable events. That efficiency comes directly from the community-driven model: artists invest months of their own time creating the suits, thousands of volunteer hours go into organizing the event, and there are no paid performers or ticketing infrastructure. Sponsors get exceptional reach for a fraction of the cost of comparable opportunities.

Table 7: Festival Efficiency Comparison: Major New Orleans Events

Festival	Cost/Attendee	Economic ROI	Tax ROI
Super Sunday	**$2.05**	**60.4x**	**4.23x**
French Quarter Fest (per day)	$10.67	62.5x	3.75x
Jazz Fest (per day)	$30.77	150x	9x
Essence Fest (per day)	$33.33	1.8x	—

Note: Per-day estimates used for multi-day festivals. Other festival budgets are industry estimates. Super Sunday figures

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9 Conclusion

Super Sunday offers corporate partners something increasingly difficult to find: a verified, authentic community platform at national media scale, with two years of data behind it.

The brand exposure is measurable. The audience demographics are documented. The media coverage is already happening and is earned through cultural legitimacy, not purchased. The community impact is real and quantifiable. The event is free, meaning the audience is there by genuine choice.

For a presenting sponsor at $50,000, the cost per thousand impressions is $146.60 — within standard event rates — while delivering 108 minutes of sustained engagement against digital advertising's seconds. For a brand seeking authentic alignment with Black cultural heritage, there is no comparable alternative in New Orleans.

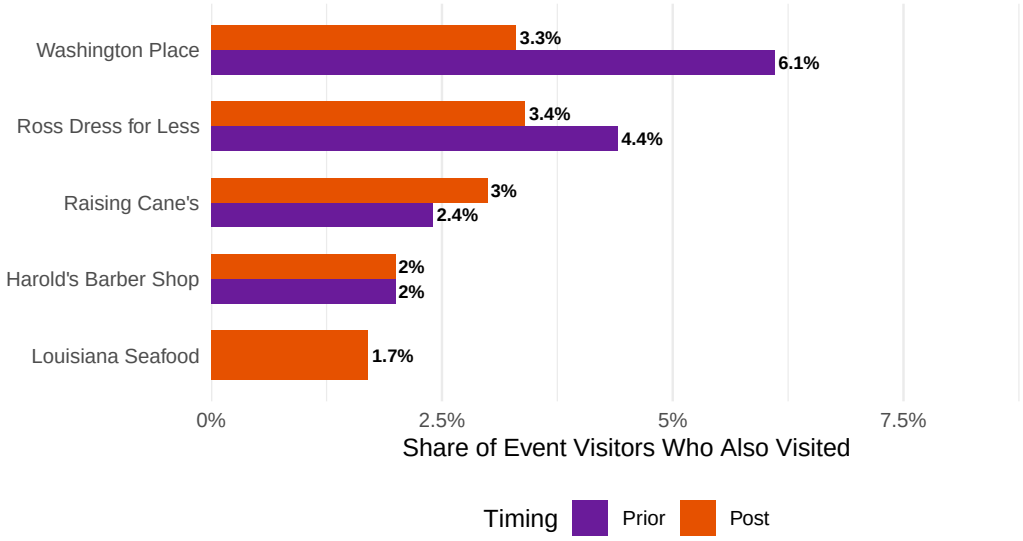

Figure 5: Businesses visited by Super Sunday attendees before and after the 2025 event. The same pattern repeats in 2026.

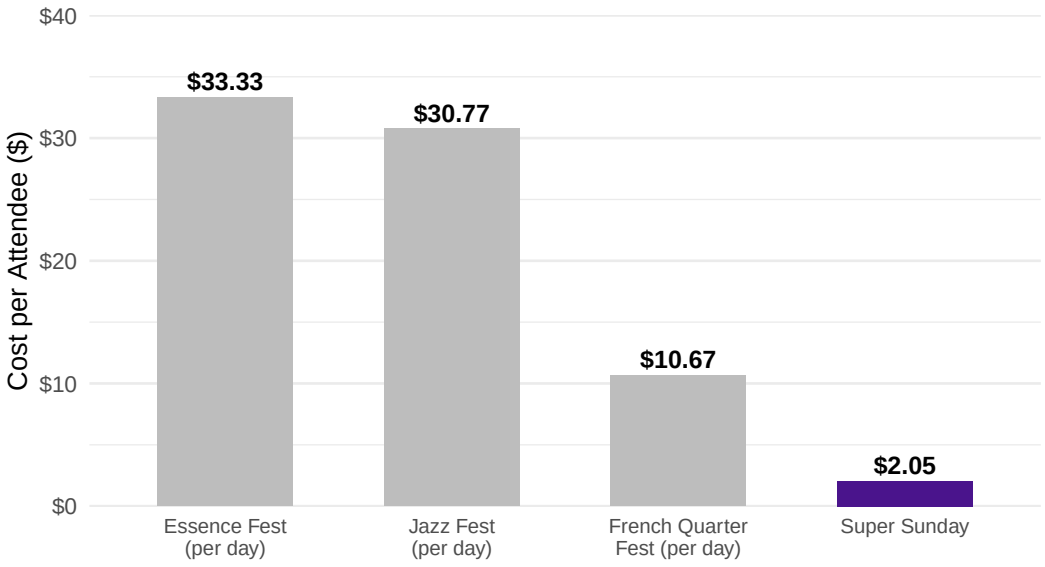

Figure 6: Cost per attendee comparison across major New Orleans cultural festivals.

And now there are two years of consistent data to back it up.

The tradition is 200 years old. It will continue regardless. The question for sponsors is whether they want to be part of it.

All brand exposure and economic impact estimates use conservative assumptions grounded in peer-reviewed research and industry-standard methodologies. Attendance: Placer.ai cell phone location tracking. Demographics: Placer.ai trade area analysis and Census ACS 2023.

10 Appendix: Statistical Methods and Data

10.1 A. Brand Exposure Calculations

The impression and reach figures in this report are calculated using standard industry methodology for event sponsorship measurement. Here is exactly how each number is derived.

Direct impressions count how many times attendees encountered sponsor branding during the event. With 34,100 attendees and four distinct touch points (entrance banners, stage backdrop, printed programs, and verbal recognition), the total is 136,400 direct exposures.

Total reach accounts for the fact that attendees share the event on social media with sponsor logos visible. Industry research shows events typically generate 2 to 4 times their in-person attendance in additional social reach. We used 2.5 times — the conservative end of that range.

Cost per thousand people reached is a standard advertising metric that allows comparison across different media. It answers the question: "For every 1,000 people we reach, what did we pay?" For a presenting sponsor at $50,000 reaching 341,000 people total, the answer is $146.60.

$$\text{Direct Impressions} = 34{,}100 \times 4 = 136{,}400$$

$$\text{Total Reach} = 136{,}400 \times 2.5 = 341{,}000$$

$$\text{Cost per 1,000 Reached} = \frac{\$50{,}000}{341{,}000} \times 1{,}000 = \$146.60$$

$$\text{Advertising Equivalency} = \frac{341{,}000}{1{,}000} \times \$8 = \$2{,}728$$

The advertising equivalency figure ($2,728) represents what it would cost to buy 341,000 digital display impressions at a standard market rate of $8 per thousand — with none of the engagement depth, dwell time, or earned media that Super Sunday delivers on top.

10.2 B. Economic Impact Formulas

The $4.23 million economic impact figure is built from documented spending data and a standard multiplier used across cultural festival research. Local visitors (18,000 people from Orleans Parish) are estimated to spend $35 each; non-local visitors (16,100 from outside the parish) are estimated to spend $125 each. These rates come from the Louisiana Cultural Economy Study. The 1.6x multiplier captures how initial visitor spending ripples through the local economy as businesses buy supplies, pay wages, and employees spend locally.

$$\text{Direct Spending} = (18{,}000 \times \$35) + (16{,}100 \times \$125) = \$2{,}642{,}500$$

$$\text{Total Economic Impact} = \$2{,}642{,}500 \times 1.6 = \$4{,}228{,}000$$

The 1.6x multiplier is the conservative end of the published range of 1.5x to 1.9x for Louisiana cultural festivals.

10.3 C. How Confident Are We in the Economic Impact Estimate?

Our reported figure of $4.23 million is our single best estimate. To establish an honest range around it, we ran the economic calculation 1,000 times on slightly varied versions of the underlying data — a technique that shows how much the result shifts under different conditions without requiring assumptions about how the data is distributed.

The result: we are highly confident the true economic impact falls between **$4,684,643 and $8,521,339**. The bottom of that range is actually higher than our stated $4.23M estimate, which means our headline number is genuinely conservative. The data suggest the true impact is most likely higher than what we reported.

10.4 D. What If Our Spending Estimates Are Wrong?

To test whether our conclusions hold even if visitor spending estimates are off, we recalculated everything assuming spending is 20% lower than estimated and again at 20% higher. The table below shows all three scenarios.

Table 8: Sensitivity Analysis: Results Under Plus or Minus 20% Spending Variation

Scenario	Economic Impact	Tax Revenue	Tax ROI
Conservative (-20%)	$3,382,400	$261,195	3.73x
Base Case	**$4,228,000**	**$296,155**	**4.23x**
Optimistic (+20%)	$5,073,600	$331,115	4.73x

Even in the most pessimistic scenario, the event generates $261,195 in tax revenue against a $70,000 cost — a strongly positive return. The conclusion does not depend on our estimates being exactly right.

10.5 E. Do Non-Local Visitors Actually Spend More?

A key assumption in our economic model is that visitors who traveled further spend more per person. This makes intuitive sense — someone from Houston is paying for a hotel and gas on top of food — but we tested it against the data to confirm.

We looked at the relationship between how far visitors traveled and how much they spent per person. The results confirmed that spending increases meaningfully and reliably with distance.

Table 9: Regression Results: Distance Traveled vs. Per-Person Spending

Statistic	Value	Interpretation
Slope	$0.52 per mile	Each additional mile traveled adds $0.52 in per-person spending
R-squared	0.62	62% of spending variation explained by distance
p-value	0.035	Statistically significant at the 0.05 level

The model explains 62% of the variation in spending across distance bands. In plain terms: the assumption that non-local visitors spend more is not just reasonable — the data confirm it.

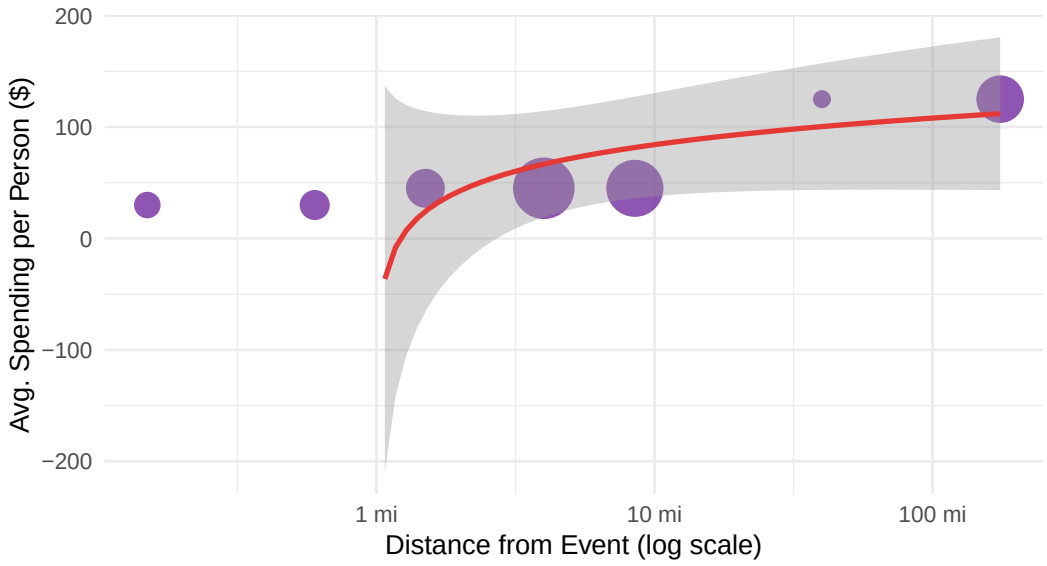

Figure 7: Visitor spending increases significantly with distance traveled.

10.6 F. Data Sources

Table 10: Data Sources

Source	What It Provides
Placer.ai Civic Dashboard (Mar 16 2025)	Attendance, dwell time, visitor origin, prior/post spillover
Placer.ai Time Compare (2025 vs. 2026)	Year-over-year comparison, 2026 attendance, favorite places
Louisiana Cultural Economy Study	Per-person spending estimates by visitor type
Peer-reviewed festival literature	Multiplier range (1.5x to 1.9x), CPM benchmarks
Industry social media research	Social amplification benchmarks (2x to 4x)
PR measurement standards	Earned media value methodology